

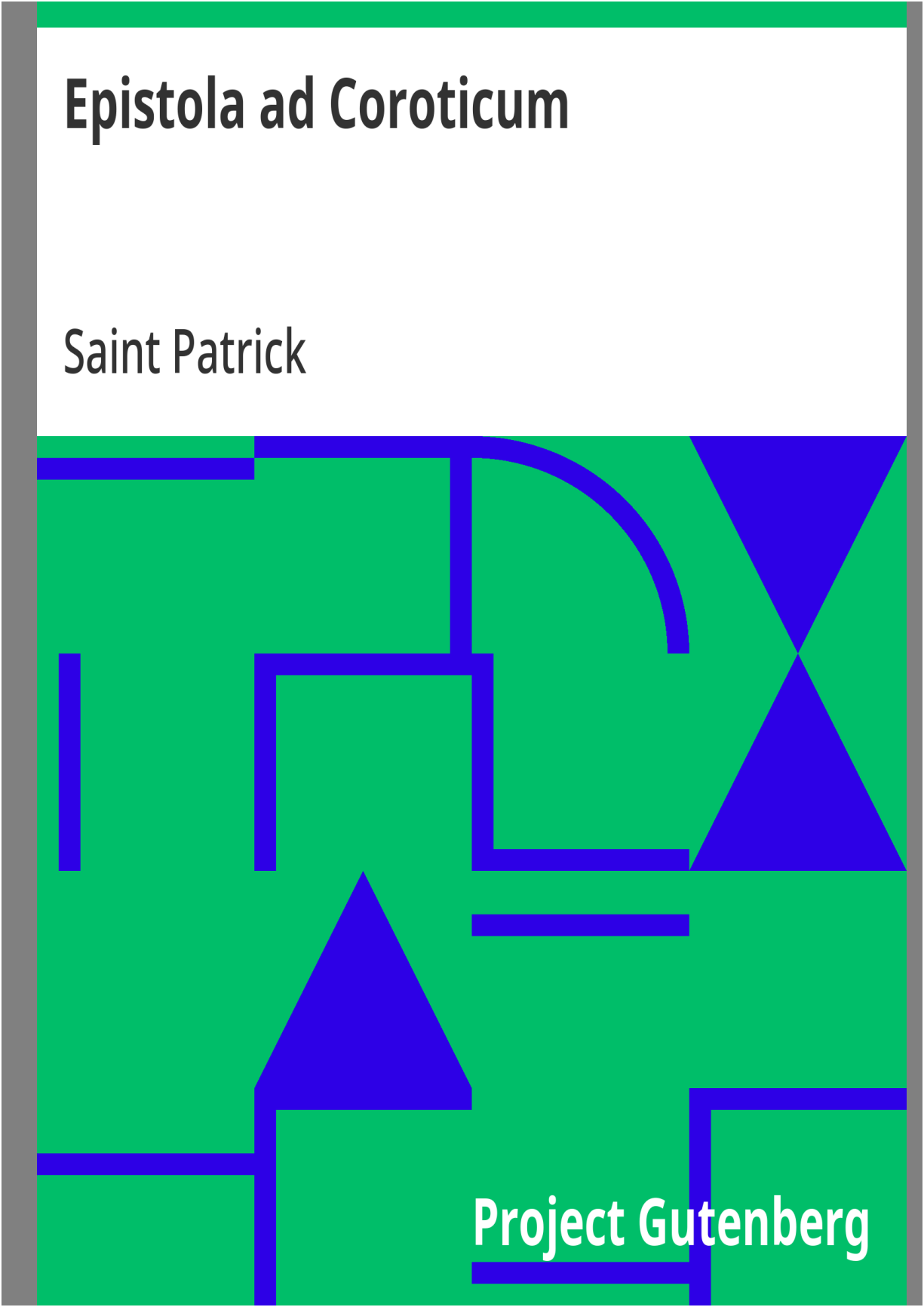
Epistola ad Coroticum

Saint Patrick

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*** START OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK EPISTOLA AD
COROTICUM ***

EPISTOLA AD COROTICUM.

I. Patricius, peccator, indoctus scilicet Hiberione constitutum episcopum me esse fateor. Certissime reor, a Deo accepi id quod sum. Inter barbaros itaque

habito proselytus et profuga, ob amorem Dei Testis est ille, si ita est: non quod optabam tam dure et tam aspere, ex ore meo effundere, sed cogor zelo Dei et veritatis Christi, (*qui*) excitavit me pro dilectione proximorum atque filiorum, pro quibus tradidi patriam et parentes et animam meam usque ad mortem, si dignus sum. Vovi Deo meo docere gentes, etsi contenmor a quibus manu mea scripsi atque condidi verba ista danda et tradenda militibus mittenda Corotico, non dico civibus meis, neque civibus sanctorum Romanorum, sed civibus dæmoniorum, ob mala opera ipsorum, ritu hostili. In morte vivunt socii Scottorum atque Pictorum apostatarum, quasi sanguine volentes saginari innocentium Christianorum, quos ego innumeros Deo genui atque in Christo confirmavi.

II. Postera die qua chrismati neophyti in veste candida, dum (fides) flagrabat in fronte ipsorum, crudeliter trucidati atque mactati (sunt) gladio a supradictis, misi epistolam cum sancto presbytero, quem ego ex infantia docui cum clericis, ut nobis aliquid indulgerent de præda vel de captivis baptizatis quos ceperunt: (*sed*) cachinnos fecerunt de illis. Idcirco nescio quos magis lugeam, an qui interfecti, vel quos ceperunt, vel quos graviter zabulus illaqueavit, (*qui*) perenni pœna gehennæ pariter cum ipso mancipabuntur. Quia utique peccati, qui facit peccatum, servus est (*I Joan.* III, 8), et fllius zabuli nuncupatur.

III. Quapropter sciat omnis homo timens Deum quod a me alieni sunt et a Christo Domino meo pro quo legatione fungor, patricidæ, fratricidæ, lupi rapaces, *devorantes plebem Domini, ut cibum panis (Psal. XIII, 4)*, sicut ait: *Iniqui dissipaverunt legem tuam, Domine (Psal. CXVIII, 126)*, qua in supremis temporibus Hiberione optime et benigne plantata atque instructa erat favente Deo. Non usurpo (aliena: sed) partem habeo cum his quos advocavit, et prædestinavit Evangelium prædicare in persecutionibus non parvis usque ad extremum terræ. Etsi invidet inimicus per tyrannidem Corotici, qui Deum non veretur, nec sacerdotes ipsius quos elegit et indulsit illis summam, divinam, sublimem potestatem, *quos ligarent super terram, ligatos esse et in cælis (Matth. XVIII, 18)*.

IV. Unde ergo quæso plurimum, sancti et humiles corde, adulari talibus non licet, nec cibum nec potum sumere cum ipsis, nec eleemosynas ipsorum recipere debere, donec crudeliter effusis lacrymis satis Deo faciant et

liberent servos Dei et ancillas Christi baptizatas, pro quibus mortuus est et crucifixus. *Dona iniquorum reprobatur Altissimus. Qui offert sacrificium ex substantia pauperum, quasi qui victimat filium in conspectu patris sui* (Eccli. XXXIV, 23, 24). *Divitiæ, inquit, quas congregabit injustus, evomentur de ventre ejus; trahit illum angelus mortis: ira draconum multabitur: interficiet illum lingua colubri* (Job XX, 15, 16). Comedet autem eum ignis inexstinguibilis. Ideoque vae qui replent se (his) quæ non sum sua. Vel, *quid prodest homini, ut totum mundum lucretur, et animæ suæ detrimentum patiatur* (Matth. XVI, 26)? Longum est per singula discutere vel insinuare, per totam legem carpere testimonia de tali cupiditate. Avaritia mortale crimen. *Non concupisces rem proximi tui. Non occides* (Exod. XX, 17, 13). Homicida non potest esse cum Christo. *Qui odit fratrem suum, homicida ascribitur; vel, qui non diligit fratrem suum in morte manet* (I Joan. III, 14, 15). Quanto magis reus est qui manus suas coinquinavit in sanguine filiorum Dei, quos nuper acquisivit in ultimis terræ, per exhortationem parvitatæ nostræ?

V. Nunquid sine Deo vel secundum carnem Hiberione veni? Quis me compulit? alligatus sum spiritu, ut non videam aliquem de cognatione mea. Nunquid piam misericordiam ago erga gentem illam quæ me aliquando ceperunt, et devastaverunt servos et ancillas domus patris mei? Ingenuus fui secundum carnem: decorione patre nascor. Vendidi enim nobilitatem meam (non erubesco, neque me pœnitet) pro utilitate aliorum. Denique servus sum in Christo Jesu Domino nostro, etsi mei me non cognoscunt. *Propheta in patria sua honorem, non habet* (Marc. VI, 4). Forte non sumus ex uno ovili, neque unum Deum patrem habemus, sicut ait: *Qui non est mecum contra me est, et qui non congregat mecum spargit* (Luc. XI, 23). Non convenit, *Unus destruit, alter ædificat* (Eccli. XXXIV, 28). Non quæro quæ mea sunt.

VI. Non mea gratia; sed Deus quidem hanc sollicitudinem (dedit) in corde meo, ut unus essem de venatoribus sive piscatoribus quos olim Deus in novissimis diebus ante prænuntiavit (Jer. XXVI, 16). Invidetur mihi: Quid faciam Domine? Valde despicio. Ecce oves tuæ circa me laniantur atque deprædantur a supradictis latrunculis, jubente Corotico, hostili mente (longe est a caritate Dei traditor Christianorum), in manus Scottorum atque Pictorum. Lupi rapaces deglutierunt gregem Domini, qui utique Hiberione cum summa diligentia optime crescebat; et filii Scottorum et filiæ

regulorum monachi fiebant et virgines Christi; quos enumerare nequeo. Quamobrem injuria justorum non tibi placeat, etiam usque ad inferos non placebit.

VII. Quis sanctorum non horreat jocundare vel convivio frui cum talibus? De spoliis defunctorum Christianorum repleverunt domos suas; de rapinis vivunt, nesciunt miseri. Venenum bibunt, lethalem cibum porrigunt ad amicos et filios suos. Sicut Eva non intellexit quod mortem tradidit viro suo; sic sunt omnes qui male agunt, mortem perennem pœnamque perpetuam operantur. Consuetudo Romanorum et Gallorum Christianorum (est): mittunt viros sanctos idoneos ad Francos et cæteras gentes cum tot millibus solidorum ad redimendos captivos baptizatos. Tu omnes interficis, et vendis illos genti exteræ ignorantem Deum: quasi in lupanar tradis membra Christi. Qualem spem habes in Deum?

VIII. Qui tecum sentit, aut qui communicat verbis alienis et adulationis, Deus judicabit. Scriptum est enim: *Non solum facientes mala, sed etiam consentientes damnandi sunt* (Rom. I, 32). Nescio quid dicam aut quid loquar amplius de defunctis filiorum Dei, quos gladius supra modum dure tetigit. Scriptum est enim: *Flere cum flentibus* (Rom. XII, 15); et iterum: *Si dolet unum membrum, condoleant omnia membra* (I Cor. XII, 26).

Quapropter Ecclesia plorat et plangit filios et filias suas quas adhuc gladius nondum interfecit, sed prolongati et exportati (sunt) in longa terrarum spatia... Ut peccatum manifeste gravetur impudentiæ, impudens ibi habitat et abundat. Ibi venundati ingenui homines Christiani in servitutem redacti sunt, præsertim indignissimorum, pessimorum, apostatarumque Pictorum.

IX. Idcirco cum tristitia et mærore vociferabor: O speciosissimi atque amantissimi fratres et filii quos in Christo genui, enumerare nequeo quid faciam vobis! Non sum dignus Deo neque hominibus subvenire. Prævaluit iniquitas iniquorum super nos. Quasi extranei facti sumus. Forte non credunt (quod) unum baptismum percipimus, vel, unum Deum patrem habemus. Indignum est illis; Hiberia nati sumus, sicut ait: nonne unum Deum habetis? Quid dereliquistis unusquisque proximum suum? Idcirco doleo pro vobis, doleo, carissimi mihi; sed iterum gaudeo intra meipsum; non gratis laboravi, vel peregrinatio mea in vacuum non fuit; et contigit scelus tam horrendum, ineffabile. Deo gratias, creduli baptizati de sæculo

recessistis ad paradisum. Cerno: vos migrare cœpistis ubi *nox non erit neque luctus, neque mors amplius* (Apoc. XXI, 4); sed exsultabitis sicut vituli ex vinculis resoluti, et conculcabitis iniquos, et erunt cinis sub pedibus vestris.

X. Vos ergo regnabitis cum apostolis et prophetis atque martyribus, et æterna regna capietis, sicut ipse testatur (qui inquit): *Venient ab Oriente et Occidente, et recumbent cum Abraham et Isaac et Jacob in regno cœlorum* (Matth. VIII, 11). *Foris canes, et venefici, et homicidæ, et mendaces* (Apoc. XXII, 15), perjuri: *Pars eorum in stagnum ignis æternum* (Apoc. XXI, 8). Non immerito ait Apostolus: *Ubi justus vix salvus erit, peccator et impius transgressor legis, ubi se recognoscit* (II Petr. IV, 18). Ubi enim Coroticus cum suis sceleratissimis rebellatoribus Christi? Ubi se videbunt, qui mulierculas baptizadas et prædia orphanorum spurcissimis satellitibus suis distribuunt ob miserum regnum temporale, quod utique in momento transeat, sicut nubes, vel fumus qui utique vento dispergitur? Ita peccatores et fraudulentum a facie Domini peribunt: justus autem epulabuntur in magna constantia cum Christo: judicabunt nationes et regibus iniquis dominabuntur in sæcula sæculorum. Amen.

XI. Testificor coram Deo et angelis suis, quod ita erit sicut intimavit imperitia mea. Non mea verba, sed Dei, et apostolorum atque prophetarum (quod ego in Latinum exposui), qui nunquam enim mentiti sunt. *Qui crediderit, salvus erit; qui vero non crediderit condemnabitur* (Marc. XVI, 16). Deus locutus est. Quæso plurimum, ut quicumque famulus Dei, ut promptus fuerit, ut sit gerulus litterarum harum, ut neutiquam subtrahatur a nemine, sed magis potius legatur coram cunctis plebibus, et coram ipso Corotico. Quod si Deus inspirat illos ut quandoque Deo resipiscant, et vel sero pœniteant quod tam impie gesserunt homicidæ erga fratres Domini, et liberent captivas baptizadas quas ante ceperunt, ita ut mereantur Deo vivere, et sani efficiantur hic et in æternum. Pax Patri, et Filio, et Spiritui sancto. Amen.

*** END OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK EPISTOLA AD
COROTICUM ***

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